



GRADUATE DIPLOMA IN MANAGEMENT

May 2025

GDM 601 – Leadership and Management in a Digital Economy

(Batch 85)

Case Study (Pre-seen)

Qualification	ATHE Level 6 Graduate Diploma in Management
Issued Date	24 May 2025
Module Tutor	Sanduni Wickramarachchi, <i>BSc</i>
Exam Date & Time	1 June 2025 - 9.00 a.m.–12.10 p.m.

Learning Outcomes:

By the end of this unit students will be able to:

- LO1:** Understand the approaches to leadership and management to meet organizational objectives
- LO2:** Apply theories of management and leadership to support teams in achieving goals

LARRY PAGE: BUILDING GREAT THINGS THAT DO NOT EXIST

Larry Page co-founded Google Inc., a leading multinational company, in 1998, and he was identified as one of the ten most powerful people in the world in 2014 by Forbes. When Larry Page took over as CEO in 2011, Google was facing several challenges. The company was struggling to maintain its growth momentum in the face of increasing competition from rivals like Apple and Facebook. Page also inherited a company that was criticized for being bureaucratic and slow-moving, hindering innovation and agility. Moreover, Google Inc. was awarded the Best Place to Work in 2016. His ambition, collaboration, and passion for creativity led him to bring innovative ideas to develop Google, and his philosophy was “We should be building great things that don’t exist.”.

Page wanted to make employees believe in crazy ideas and accepted all their ideas since he believed those ideas could change the world. Therefore, he welcomed the ideas of employees and gathered those insights for further developments of Google. Page encouraged employees to speak up in meetings and offered constructive feedback because he believed that interpersonal communication could increase employee productivity. He constructed an open workspace for employees, which is called Googleplex, and no cubicles or walls between departments were seen. He did this to encourage employee participation and build strong teamwork at all levels of the workplace. Page treated his employees equally, and he gave them the freedom to complete their tasks to increase their creativity and innovative thinking. As an example, Google practices a program called “20 percent time,” where employees can work one day per week on a project that they find interesting. This depicts how Page was concerned with the individual consideration of employees.

Page motivated his employees through his actions, and he always demonstrated an inspirational attitude towards his employees. The ability to bring innovations, motivate employees to handle old problems in new ways, and act as a role model for employees are some of the key traits Page possessed. Therefore, the success of Google is inseparable from the leadership of Page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES AND ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Learning Outcomes	Pass	Merit	Distinction
1. Understand the approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives	1.1 Discuss different approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives	1M1 Analyse different leadership and management performance and competences to meet organisation objectives	1D1 Recommend suitable leadership and management approaches in different organisational context to meet organisation objectives and achieve goals
2. Apply theories of management and leadership to support teams in achieving goals	2.1 Apply a range of management and leadership theories to creating teams for given organisation contexts	2M1 Compare the impact of different theories of management and leadership, and their impact in given organisation contexts	

~ End of Paper ~

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